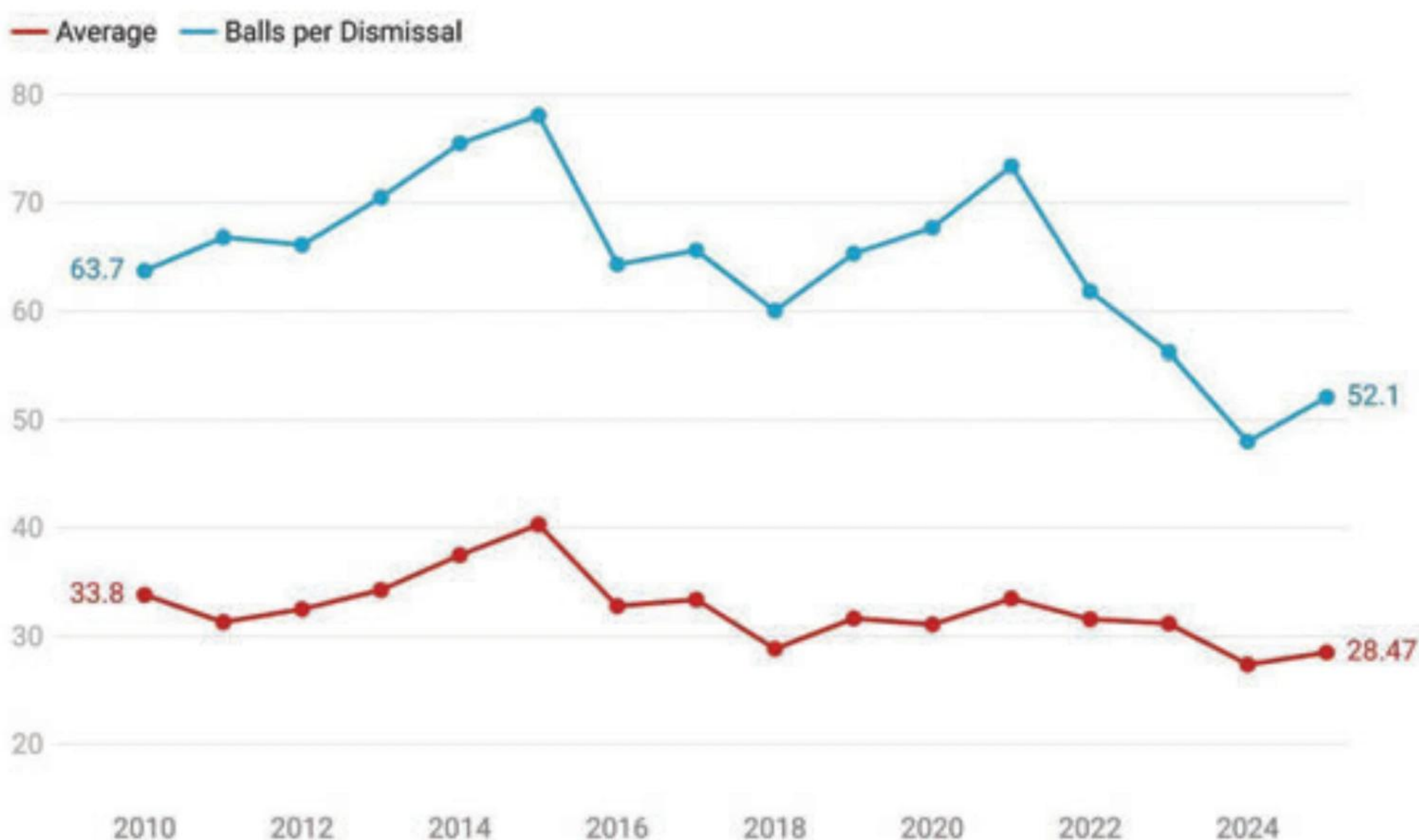


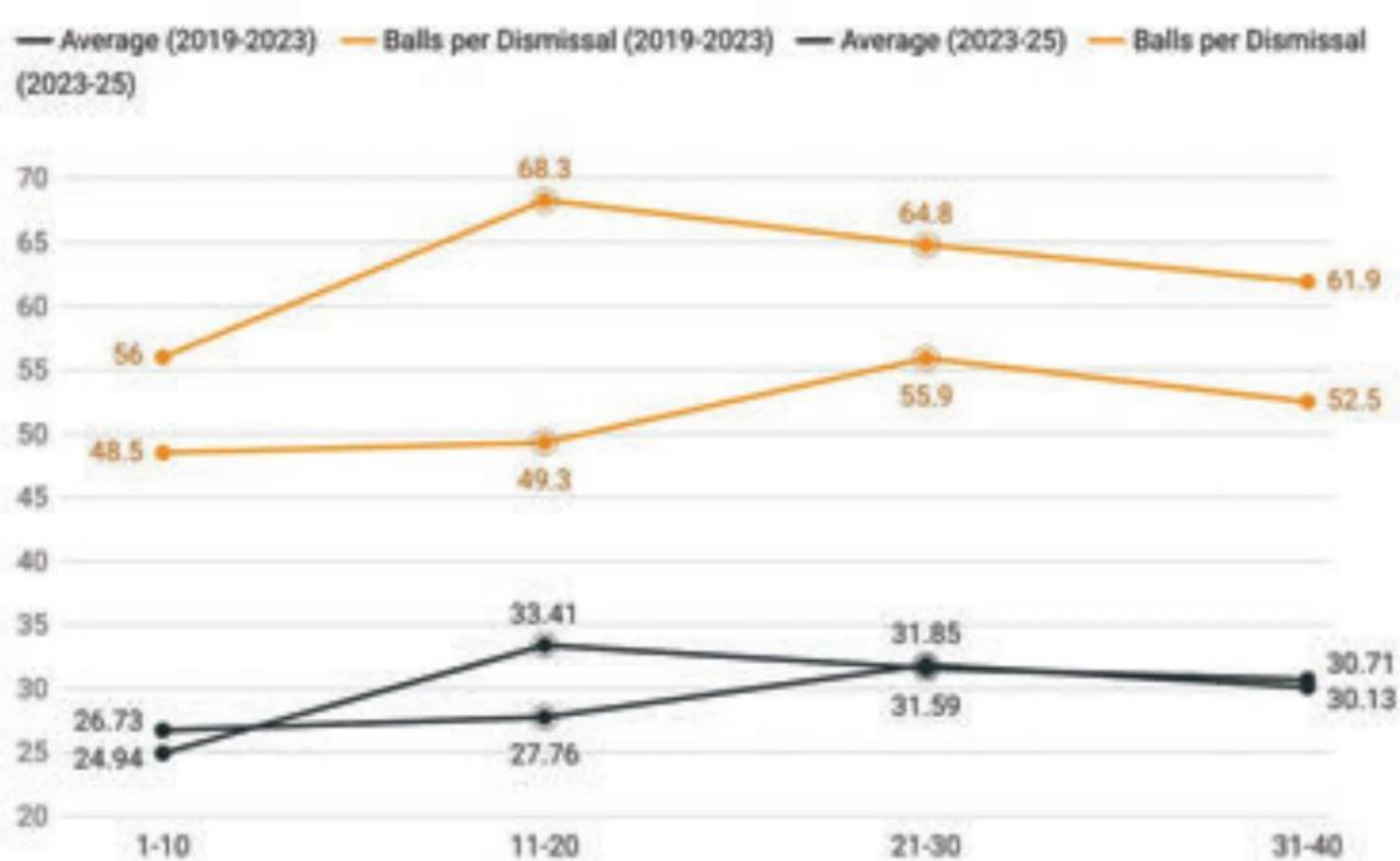
Batting average and balls per dismissal in overs 11-20

Since 2010, the batting average and balls per dismissal in overs 11-20 have shown a sharp dip. This decline is accentuated post 2018.



Batting average by phase of innings

The overs 11-20 phase shows the sharpest drop-off in both batting average and balls per dismissal.



dismissal every 58.1 balls — the second lowest and the lowest, respectively, since 2010.

Filter out outliers — like Wiaan Mulder's unbeaten 367 vs Zimbabwe — and things look worse. Between the start of the calendar year and July 1, the average drops to 28.56, and the dismissal rate to 54.2.

And the churn shows. Of the 10 batters who played at least 10 innings at number 3 during the 2023-25 WTC, only three — Kane Williamson, Ollie Pope, and Dinesh Chandimal — held that role in their team's most recent Test. Four were shuffled to new positions (Shubman Gill, Shan Masood, Kusal Mendis, Najmul Hossain Shanto), and the remaining three (Marnus Labuschagne, Kirk McKenzie, Keacy Carty) dropped altogether.

Teams have tried everything: moving openers down, sending in pinch-hitters, recalling domestic